

CSS NOTES — PART 1

Beginner-friendly • Interview-ready
Save & Revisit 📌



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INTRO TO CSS

What is CSS?

Answer:

CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) is used to style and layout HTML elements on the web.

HTML → structure

CSS → appearance

JS → behavior

Why do we need CSS?

Without CSS:

- Websites look plain
- No layout control
- Poor user experience



CSS separates content from presentation.

HOW CSS WORKS

How does the browser apply CSS?

The browser:

Reads HTML

Reads CSS

Matches selectors to elements

Applies styles

Why do some styles override others?

Because of:

- Cascade
- Specificity
- Order of rules



This explains “why my CSS is not working”.

TYPES OF CSS & CSS SYNTAX

What are the ways to apply CSS?

Inline

Internal

External

Which one is best and why?

✓ External CSS — reusable, maintainable, scalable

 Preferred in real projects & interviews.

What is the basic CSS syntax?

```
selector {  
  property: value;  
}
```

What do selectors do?

Selectors decide which HTML elements get styled

BASIC SELECTORS

What are common CSS selectors?

* → universal

p → element

.box → class

#id → id

What is a grouping selector?

Styles multiple elements at once.

```
h1, p {  
  color: black;  
}
```

CLASS vs ID | CASCADE & PRIORITY

Difference between class and id?

class → reusable

id → unique

Which one should be used more?

✓ Use classes for styling

✓ IDs only when uniqueness is required

 **IDs increase specificity.**

What is CSS cascade?

It decides which CSS rule wins when conflicts exist.

Order of CSS priority?

Inline > Internal/External > Browser styles
(When specificity is the same)

 **Order matters when specificity is same.**

SPECIFICITY | INHERITANCE

What is specificity?

It decides which selector is more important.

Element < Class < ID < Inline

Why avoid !important?

- Breaks CSS flow
- Makes code hard to maintain
- 📌 **Indicates poor CSS design**

What is inheritance in CSS?

Some properties pass from parent to child.

Which properties inherit?

- ✓ color
- ✓ font-family
- ✗ margin, padding, border

CSS UNITS | BOX MODEL

Difference between px, em, rem?

px → fixed

em → relative to parent

rem → relative to root

Which unit is preferred?

✓ rem — predictable & scalable

(rem = recommended for consistent layouts)

What is the CSS box model?

Content → Padding → Border → Margin

What does box-sizing do?

box-sizing: border-box;

Includes padding & border inside width.

DISPLAY PROPERTY | BASIC POSITIONING

Common display values?

block

inline

inline-block

none

display:none vs visibility:hidden?

display:none → removes element

visibility:hidden → space remains

What are basic position values?

static

relative

absolute

relative vs absolute?

- relative → reference point
- absolute → positioned to nearest ancestor

Foundations → Layout → Performance

Strong CSS starts with clear fundamentals.

Save this for revision 📌



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